Paper 3 - Project Documentation

Content

Your remaining writing will be represented by your project documentation. This documentation will be turned over to your sponsor at the end of the semester, and you will continue to build on it next semester. You have many tools at your disposal to build documentation:

- Github wikis let you build a wiki inside your Github repos. The Hystrix wiki is a good example.
- There are many tools for autogenerating documentation from docstrings and comments in code; e.g.:
  - pydoc for Python code
  - react-docgen for React
  - admindocs in Django
  - Swagger for generic API documentation

You can use whatever you want to produce your documentation, within the following constraints:

- Approve your documentation choice with your sponsor early. There's no point investing months in crafting beautiful documentation only to find out its useless to your end user.
- **Clear any use of AI tools with your sponsor.** These tools typically add any code they scan to the existing libraries of content they use to train themselves, and this may violate your sponsor's wishes.
- Each team member must uniquely own at least 7 pages of this documentation, and there should be no overlap in content.

Length

7 pages worth, or ~2100 words.

There's no foolproof metric to gauge how much writing you've done. UConn requires a minimum of 15 pages, or ~4500 words, of **revised writing** for a W Course. This works out to ~300 words per page.

As a practical example, the home page of the Hystrix wiki linked above contains ~900 words at the time of writing this (09/23) and so would represent ~3 pages. This is about right for the amount of content it contains. I'd count the 3 large images as ~1 page total, bringing us up to 4 pages for this (very good) wiki page. A few important caveats to watch out for:

- Long lists of links which are effectively an index, table of contents, or similar do not count towards your word limit, since they do not by themselves convey much information.
- Images are particularly tricky:
  - Images are a critical component of technical writing, and they *do* apply towards your word count.
  - Word count of images can only be determined via a discussion with your instructor. Consult with your instructor to determine the equivalent word count of any image you plan on using. **Image size is not a predictor of word count**.
  - As with any writing in your documentation, this only applies to content you create yourself. Images you copy from somewhere else may be worth including, but 1) they must be properly cited and 2) they will not count towards your word limit.
  - You will be graded on the quality of your images, just as you are graded on the quality of the rest of your writing.

Revisions

At the end of the semester, you will do peer-review of one of your teammate's documentation with the rubric below. You will then revise your documentation, at which point I will grade it using the same rubric.

Note that the grade you get during peer-review is not factored into your grade - there is no incentive to give higher or lower marks to your teammates. There is incentive to giving accurate marks - it will help you become a better writer, and your teammates will be able to get a better grade if they have good feedback.

Rubric

- Content (80%)
  - Documentation clearly describes the area you are responsible for, e.g.:
    - technical stack
    - user interface
    - front end modules/classes/functions
    - back end modules/classes/functions
- Style (20%) - Documentation style is consistent and professional